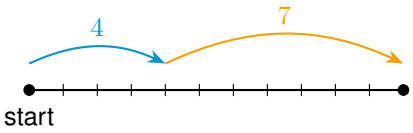
Segment Addition Postulate — Notes

Watch the video and fill in each blank. Pause when you see "Your turn."

Name: _____ Date: _____

☞ *Video: Walk 4 steps, then 7 more*

Key Idea

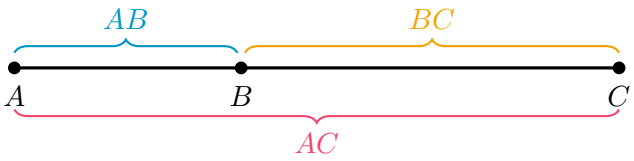


Walk 4, then 7 more.

Distance from the start: $4 + 7 =$ _____

☞ *Video: The postulate*

Key Idea



Segment Addition Postulate: If B is _____ A and C, then _____.

In words: part + part = _____.

☞ *Video: Simple cases first*

Key Idea

Find the whole: _____

$AB = 4,\ BC = 7$

$AC = AB + BC = 4 + 7 =$ _____

Know the whole and one piece: _____

$AC = 20,\ AB = 8$

$BC = AC - AB = 20 - 8 =$ _____

☞ *Video: With algebra*

© 2026 FangMath. All rights reserved.

Watch Me — Worked Example

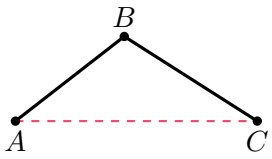
$AB = x + 3, \quad BC = 2x, \quad AC = 21.$ Find x and BC.

$(x + 3) + 2x = 21$	part + part = _____
_____ $= 21$	combine like terms
$3x =$ _____	subtract 3
$x =$ _____	**don't stop at x!**
$BC = 2(6) =$ _____	answer the question they asked

Check: $AB =$ _____, $9 + 12 = 21$ ✓

☞ *Video: Only when B is between A and C*

Common Mistake



The postulate only works when B is _____ A and C on one line.

If A, B, C make a triangle, then $AB + BC$ is _____ than AC.

☞ *Video: Your turn*

Your Turn

Q is between P and R. $\quad PQ = 3x - 1, \quad QR = x + 5, \quad PR = 24.$ Find x and PQ.

$(3x - 1) + (x + 5) = 24$

_____ $= 24 \quad \Rightarrow \quad x =$ _____

$PQ = 3(5) - 1 =$ _____ Check: $QR =$ _____, $14 + 10 = 24$ ✓

Notice

Remember: **part** + **part** = **whole** ($AB + BC = AC$ when B is between A and C). Missing piece? **Subtract** from the whole. Solve for x — then answer the question they actually asked.

© 2026 FangMath. All rights reserved.